officials from the United States, warned that the absence of alternatives "is a symptom of how many big emerging economies such as China are turning away . . . to focus on their own new institutions." According to scholar and former World Bank official Nancy Birdsall, the United States is "putting the long-term relevance, effectiveness, and legitimacy of the World Bank at risk." Influential staff asked the bank's board to conduct a global search for a replacement, but the Obama administration did not take up such calls for a change in leadership.[62]

The BRICS could not unite around a common developing country candidate.[63] They were unable to coordinate their financial statecraft positions and did not influence the selection process in any clear direction: thus, the results at both the IMF and the World Bank must be coded as failures. However, some individual BRICS were able to shake out some back-room quid pro quo deals from the incumbent powers along the way. India had been among the earliest developing countries to complain, mostly through unofficial channels, about underrepresentation of senior staff from developing countries at the Bretton Woods institutions, and in recent years, BRICS nationals have done somewhat better than previously. Indian national Raghuram Rajan served as chief economist of the IMF (2003–2006), and Chinese national Justin Yifu Lin as World Bank chief economist (2008–2012). Lin was succeeded by Kaushik Basu (2012–present), a Cornell University professor of Indian origin. Robert Wade reports that the appointment of Basu, and of Chinese economist Jin-Yong Cai (2012–2015) as chief executive officer (CEO) of the IFC, the private-sector funding wing of the World Bank, were in part rewards offered by the dominant Western powers to China and India for their flexibility and patience in the negotiations over the top positions at the World Bank and the IMF.[64]

Lagarde's active courting of China from the outset has been reflected in the creation of a new deputy managing director position in July 2011, which was filled by Zhu Min for a five-year term, but also with her firm support for the incorporation of the RMB into the SDR Reserve. Zhu was replaced by Zhang Tao in August 2016. Formerly deputy governor of the People's Bank of China (PBOC), Zhang had years of experience at the World Bank and the Asian Development Bank (ADB) and as an ED for China at the IMF from 2011 to 2015.[65] Lagarde also reappointed David Lipton and gave senior management positions to a Japanese (Takatoshi Kato), and one dual national of Brazil and Italy (Carla Grasso). At the World Bank, as of late July 2016, the two